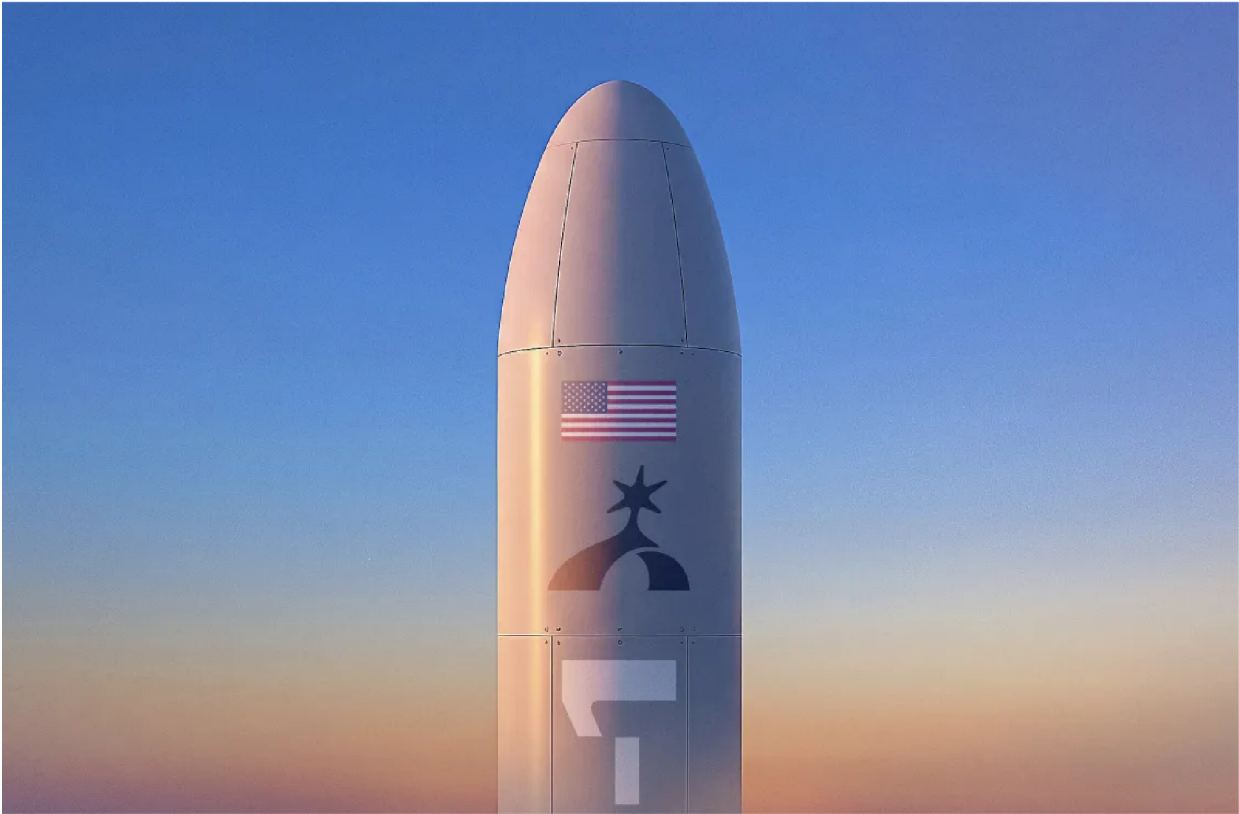


Industries | Space

Robinhood Billionaire Bhatt's Cowboy Space Raises \$275 Million



A Cowboy Space Corp. rocket. Source: Cowboy Space Corp.

By [Bruce Einhorn](#)

May 11, 2026 at 9:00 AM EDT

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✦ **Takeaways** by Bloomberg AI

- A space unicorn started by Baiju Bhatt raised \$275 million and was rebranded to Cowboy Space Corp. from Aetherflux.
- Cowboy Space Corp. plans to build data centers in orbit using its own rockets, with a target launch date of 2028.

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Index Ventures led the funding, which valued Cowboy Space at \$2 billion, the startup said Monday in a statement. Others participating in the Series B round included new investors such as Blossom Capital as well as existing investors such as Bill Gates' Breakthrough Energy Ventures and Andreessen Horowitz.

San Carlos, California-based Cowboy Space wants to use its own rockets to put data centers into orbit, an ambitious strategy that would put the company in competition with deep-pocketed rivals such as Elon Musk's SpaceX. The target date for Cowboy Space's first rocket launch is 2028.



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With Cowboy Space's plan, "the upper stage itself becomes the satellite in orbit," Bhatt said in an interview, adding that his startup isn't deterred by the problems affecting rivals with more experience making rockets.

"The launch capacity is not there," he said. "We're not going to have control of our destiny" unless Cowboy Space builds its own rockets.

The plan marks a pivot in the company's direction. It originally focused on building satellites to deliver space-based solar energy to Earth, and had announced its intention to launch a satellite aboard a SpaceX rocket.

Cowboy Space still plans to proceed with that launch later this year, Bhatt said.

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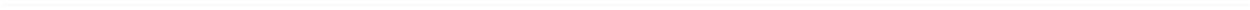
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